



Rating
Buy

Asia
Hong Kong

Consumer
Autos & Auto Technology

Company
Minth

Reuters
0425.HK

Bloomberg
425 HK

Exchange
HSI

Ticker
0425

ADR
MNTHY

ISIN
US60448A1016

Date
23 July 2026

Forecast Change

Price at 22 Jul 2026 (HKD)	27.30
Price target - 12mth (HKD)	42.30
52-week range (HKD)	46.30 - 25.95
HANG SENG INDEX	24,893

European Strength and Resilient Margin Offset Domestic China Headwinds

European New Energy Vehicle Market Sees Strong in June: BEVs / PHEVs up 51% / 22.7% YoY

According to ACEA statistics, European car registrations (covering the European Union, Iceland, Norway, Switzerland, and the UK) rose by 6.1% to 7,232,066 units in 1H 2026, with a robust performance in June (up 13.1% YoY) contributing to a positive first half, as the market continued to benefit from strong consumer demand for electrified technologies, primarily driven by market support measures and rising oil price. Battery-electric vehicles (BEVs) saw a 35.1% YoY increase, reaching 1,608,200 units in 1H 2026 and accounting for 22.2% of total European new car sales, while plug-in hybrid electric vehicles (PHEVs) captured 10.3% of the European car market with 1H 2026 volume up 24.8% YoY to 742,411 units.

In June 2026 specifically, 360,843 new BEVs were registered, marking a 51% YoY increase and capturing 25.6% of the European new car market, with strong growth in the top three largest BEV markets: Germany (+78% YoY to 84,057 units), France (+93.5% YoY to 55,851 units), and the United Kingdom (+35% YoY to 63,950 units). Registrations of PHEVs also continued to grow, reaching 146,168 units in June (up 22.7% YoY), driven by rising volumes in key markets such as Germany (+25.8% YoY to 32,212 units), the United Kingdom (+24.9% YoY to 26,702 units), Italy (+61.2% YoY to 15,627 units), and Spain (+15.3% to 15,567 units), with PHEVs representing 10.4% of overall European car registrations.

As overall European new energy vehicles (BEVs+PHEVs) sales volume increased 32% YoY in 1H 2026, we estimated Minth's interim battery house business' revenue to increase 33% YoY to RMB4.8 billion, pushing overall Minth group's total 1H 2026 revenue up 9% YoY to RMB13.4 billion.

Minth's share price highly correlated to vehicle electrification in Europe

With aluminum battery-casing production facilities located in China and Europe (Serbia, the Czech Republic, Poland, and France), Minth provides a full range of integrated services, from processing raw materials to assembling the final products. A majority of Minth's battery-casing customers are European auto makers such as Mercedes-Benz, BMW, VW, Stellantis, Renault, and Volvo Car. As such, we notice a close correlation between Europe's vehicle-electrification trend and Minth's share price. In the second half of 2023, the slowdown in automotive electrification in Europe led to a pullback in Minth's share price, from HK\$25 in

Valuation & Risks

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Key changes

TP	41.80 to 42.30	↑	1.2%
Sales (FYE)	31,741 to 29,687	↓	-6.5%
Op prof margin (FYE)	11.9 to 12.6	↑	6.0%
Net profit (FYE)	3,049.7 to 3,057.1	↑	0.2%

Source: Deutsche Bank

Deutsche Bank AG/Hong Kong

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August 2023 to HK\$10 in August 2024. When European markets' NEVs returned to growth from 4Q24, Mint's share price kept increasing, reaching HK\$46.76 in Feb 2026. Thus, given the decent growth in European NEV sales in 1H 2026, we believe Mint's share price could rally going forward.

Expected Mint's Interim Gross Margin to Improve Despite Rising Raw Material Prices

Despite rising raw material prices, particularly aluminum, posing a challenge to Mint Group's margins in 2026, the company has historically proven capable of managing such impacts, as evidenced by its Aluminum segment gross margin increasing from 32.6% in 2020 to 34% in 2021 during the last aluminum price rally (May 2020 to March 2022). Management has guided that the recent aluminum price increase will have a very limited impact on its overall gross margin in 2026, leading us to forecast Mint's 2026 interim overall gross margin to increase 0.2 percentage points (ppts) YoY to 28.5%. Consequently, we project Mint's 1H 2026 reported net profit to reach a new half-year record high of RMB 1.43 billion (up 12% YoY), driven by a combination of improving margins and decent revenue growth, especially in the European region. As a result, we have revised up Mint's full-year 2026 net profit estimate by 0.2%, leading to a DCF-derived target price of HK\$42.30 (from HK\$41.80).

Mint: A Top Pick in China Auto Sector Driven by Profit Growth and Overseas Exposure Amidst Industry Headwinds

We rank Mint Group as our top pick in the China auto sector, anticipating double-digit profit growth, which stands out against the backdrop of falling China passenger vehicle wholesales volume, down 5.9% YoY in 1H 2026 due to an 18.4% YoY drop in domestic retail volume that has been partially offset by a 72.5% YoY jump in vehicle exports. Concurrently, automakers have faced rising input costs, with sector-average LFP battery-cell prices increasing sequentially from RMB 360 per kWh in January to RMB 390 per kWh in June, and DRAM prices recording a meaningful ~50% QoQ increase in Q2 2026, directly impacting vehicle makers. Beyond input cost pressures, automakers have also suffered from reduced government support in 2026, hurting vehicle selling prices; specifically, effective January 1st, 2026, the Chinese government began levying a 5% vehicle purchase tax on all NEV purchases, and the vehicle trade-in subsidy per vehicle amount also declined compared to 2025. Further impacting the landscape, the Chinese government recently announced a reform of vehicle and vessel tax, effective January 1, 2027, which will remove tax exemptions for plug-in hybrid electric vehicles (including range-extended vehicles), pure electric commercial vehicles, and fuel-cell commercial vehicles. As a result of these challenges, we prefer companies with higher overseas exposure, such as BYD and Chery, which are targeting 1.8 million and 1.6 million units in overseas sales respectively in 2026. Mint also benefits from healthy overseas exposure, with 62% of its total revenue originating from overseas in 2H 2025.

Valuation and Risk

Our target price is derived via a discounted cash flow (DCF) analysis and implies 13.4x 2026E P/E. Despite the shortcomings of the DCF valuation method, we think it is the most appropriate method for valuing growing companies. We choose a five-year forecast time horizon for our DCF, which captures the full maturation of the two mega trends of China's auto industry – electrification and intelligentization. We apply an 7.9% WACC for our equity valuation. Our key assumptions include 3.3% cost of debt, a 3.5% risk-free rate, a 6.0% market risk premium, a beta of 1.0, a 15%



income tax rate, a 73.7% equity/equity + debt ratio, and a 0.5% terminal growth rate (TGR), consistent with our regional coverage.

Key downside risks: (a) lower-than-expected battery casing volume due to a weaker-than-expected new energy vehicle sales recovery because of more favorable policy exit, (b) lower margins due to upstream auto makers' requirements for more price reductions amid sector-wide price competition.



Appendix 1

Important Disclosures

*Other information available upon request

Disclosure checklist			
Company	Ticker	Recent price*	Disclosure
Mint	0425.HK	27.3 (HKD) 22 Jul 2026	14, 24

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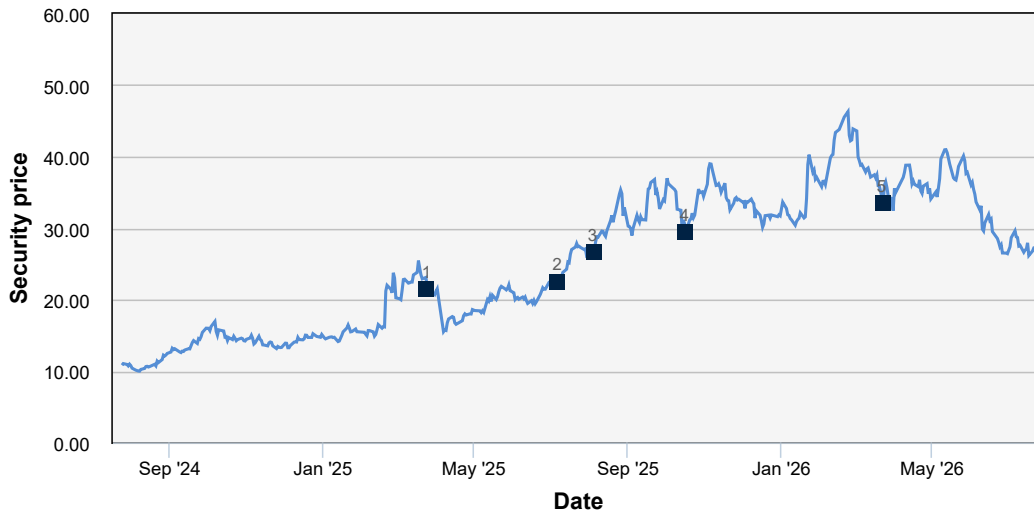
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Historical recommendations and target price: Mint (0425.HK)

(as of 07/22/2026)



Current Recommendations

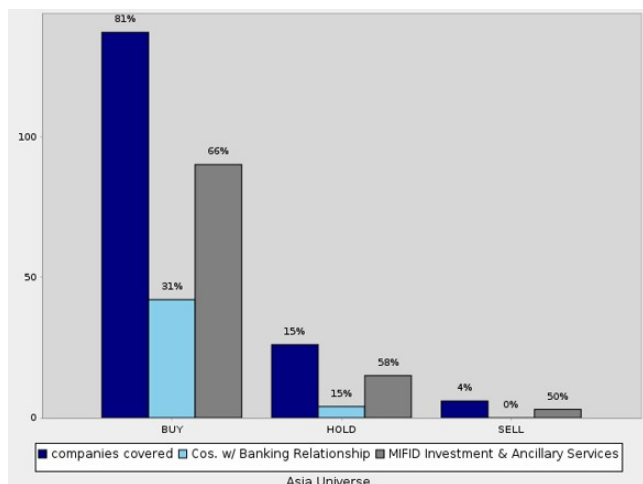
Buy
Hold
Sell
Not Rated
Suspended Rating

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2.	07/07/2025	Buy, Target Price Change HKD 30.00, Current Price HKD 22.50 Bin Wang	5.	03/23/2026	Buy, Target Price Change HKD 41.80, Current Price HKD 33.58 Bin Wang
3.	08/05/2025	Buy, Target Price Change HKD 35.00, Current Price HKD 26.66 Bin Wang			



Equity rating dispersion and banking relationships



Equity Rating and Dispersion Key

The Equity Rating Dispersion Chart depicts the following:

The proportion of recommendations that are rated "buy", "sell" and "hold" over the previous 12 months. This is shown for securities issued in the stated region e.g. "Europe Universe". See rating definitions below. This is represented by the "Companies Covered" bars in the chart. The percentage value displayed above the bar is the proportion as a percentage. E.g. 50% above the "buy" / "Companies Covered" bar means that 50% of DB's equity research covered companies over the past 12 months have a "buy" rating.

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